200 E 186th Street
Westfield, IN 46074
www.GOesportscenter.com

Media Contact: Julia Saltsgaver – 317. 796.2484
For Immediate Release: September 16, 2017

Mayor Cook Joins Partners to Launch Game On Esports Center
Grand Park Continues to Build Out with New Destination Experience

Out of the basement and into the arena, esports is a multi-million-dollar powerhouse international experience with participants and partners from all walks.

Rick Baretto, Dream Authentics chief visionary officer and other partners are launching the first Game On esports center at Jonathan Byrd's Grand Park Field House to elevate this wide-spread interest in Indiana. Game On will host esports leagues, tournaments and individuals.

With 80 state of the art, high speed computers, Game On will be the leader hosting competitive video game teams, leagues, tourneys and other exciting events centered around specific games releases such as League of Legends and Overwatch. Memberships and drop in play will enable gamers of all interests to play.

-----insert Mayor Cook quote ----

Game On is a world class esports and educational concept that will expand to other markets to maximize its mission to entertain, educate and inspire. Game On's state-of-the-art centers will provide leading-edge esports experiences, technology, content and development through leagues and tournaments. Player training and development programs will also be offered.

"When you mention gaming, people typically think of a kid playing an online game into the early morning hours," said Rick Baretto, Dream Authentics chief visionary officer, "Think again! It is really a new frontier in entertainment, education and competition that attracts millions of participants, spectators and brands."

Mainstream business experts including Deloitte and AdAge along with sports and gaming leaders at Newszoo and Global Sports Insights all are declaring booming growth. While exact growth projections vary, recent revenue figures indicate that what once was a game sold for at-home enjoyment is now a major world-wide industry.

Esports infrastructure is very like that of more traditional sports. Competition venues, established professional and amateur status leagues, consistent regulations, dedicated sports media coverage, training programs and broadcast partnerships have all come to this platform. A recent international tournament took place in Seattle with 16 international professional teams, more than $23 million in prize money, thousands of in-person and online spectators and a full cadre of broadcast analysts. Add to that,

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leading sports leagues including the NBA are now sanctioning esports leagues as an extension of their brand to engage a whole new fan base and stay relevant as technology continues to evolve how, when and where people play.

High schools and colleges are declaring gaming a varsity sport, offering scholarships and national sanctioning bodies now exist. These same colleges have upped their tech education offerings as well with New Media, Animation and Creative Digital Development degrees and concentrations. Game design, software developers, audio engineers, writers, translators, animation and musical opportunities are among the emerging esports careers.

And those same skills and education are now essential to the growing digital economy here in central Indiana with thousands of tech and digital service sector jobs recently recruited to central Indiana.

Game On's forward-thinking leaders have seen first-hand that esports offers numerous benefits and opportunities for participants and can help fill the economic, education and workforce development pipeline.

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Game On at Jonathon Byrd Fieldhouse at Grand Park is central Indiana's exclusive esports center designed specifically for gamers, with the best gear and more than 80 of high-speed gaming stations. You can play your game your way alongside other gamers for single and multi-player fun. Hone your skills, get an adrenaline rush and sharpen your focus in Game On tournaments and leagues or just drop in when you want a break from the every day. Game On offers esports competitors and the casual gamer alike the ultimate in access to an international competition, entertainment and education format! If you're just getting started, see what all the fun is about, meet other gamers and check out the most sought after online games! Or, if you want to take it further Game On can connect you to international competitions, college scholarships and emerging careers in all things gaming.

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Game On & Esports By the Numbers

Game On Esports Center

Cabinet manufacturers – rick is providing this
Consoles

Open Play – low cost hourly rate
Membership Packages - $25 to $50/monthly with unlimited open play
Leagues – NBA2K, Madden 18, Overwatch, CSGO, League of Legends, Call of Duty, Destiny 2

College and University Esports Offerings -

Indiana Tech – varsity sports team with scholarships available
National Association of Collegiate esports
- more than 40 schools in U. S. with more than 100 by 2018
- nearly $7 million in total scholarship offerings
- many offer up to 50 to 70 percent of in-state tuition

Big Ten schools – all but 2 schools have teams and offer scholarships

NBA 2K esports league –

inaugural group of 17 NBA teams including the Indiana Pacers
gamer drafts, playoffs and league championship
Paul George, Jared Jeffries, Rick Fox among many current and former NBA players committed to esports

Industry Strength and Projected Growth

Newszoo esports industry resource – 41% global growth from $696 million in 2017 to $1.5 billion in 2020
Global Sports Insights.com - $900 million industry
Deloitte Global - $400 million in 2016; 150 million viewers
AdAge – projects $1.2 billion major brand investment

International Tournaments – spectators, media and money

Dota 2 T17 – 18 teams, 70,000 live spectators, $23 million in total prize pool
Call of Duty World League – 32 teams; one stage garnered 50,000 online viewers for one match, $1.5 million top prize money
League of Legends 2016 – 43 million unique visitors and $6.7 million prize pool and 100 million users a month
Top 30 Players world-wide each earned more than $1 million in 2016
Top game-related video star has 40 million followers

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Media Coverage

- Mainstream
  - ESPN
  - Sports Illustrated
- Esports specific
  - Twitch – acquired by Amazon for $1 billion in 2014
- MLGtv - Major League Gaming, tournament operator; parent company Activision Blizzard,

Game Recruiter Employment and Career Trends

- Game Designer – create story and game mechanics
- Game Tester - Xbox, Wii, PlayStation and various mobile platforms
- Artist -2 & 3D concepts and animation
- Audio Engineers – compose musical score and soundtrack
- Software Developers and Programmer – create code and tools

Advisory – who what when where

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Who: **Mayor Andy Cook, Westfield**
Rick Baretto, Game On & Dream Authentics
Andy Card, Klipsch-Card
Scott Spillman, Hamilton County Sports Authority

What: **Game On Esports Center Launch**

Where: **Johnathan Byrd's Fieldhouse at Grand Park**
200 East 186th Street
Westfield, IN 46074

When: **Saturday, September 16, 6 – 7:30 pm**
Remarks at 6:30

Why: Mayor Cook along with Barretto, Card and Spillman will gather with community leaders and esports influencers to launch the newest competitive experience at Grand Park and bring this emerging concept to central Indiana.